



Audience Recognition

Audience Recognition

Who is your audience?

What does this reader or listener know?

What does this reader or listener not know?

What must you write or say to ensure that your audience understands your point?

How do you communicate to more than one person (multiple audiences)?

What is this person's attitude toward your topic?

What diversity issues (gender, sexual orientation, cultural, multicultural) must you consider?

What Motivates People?

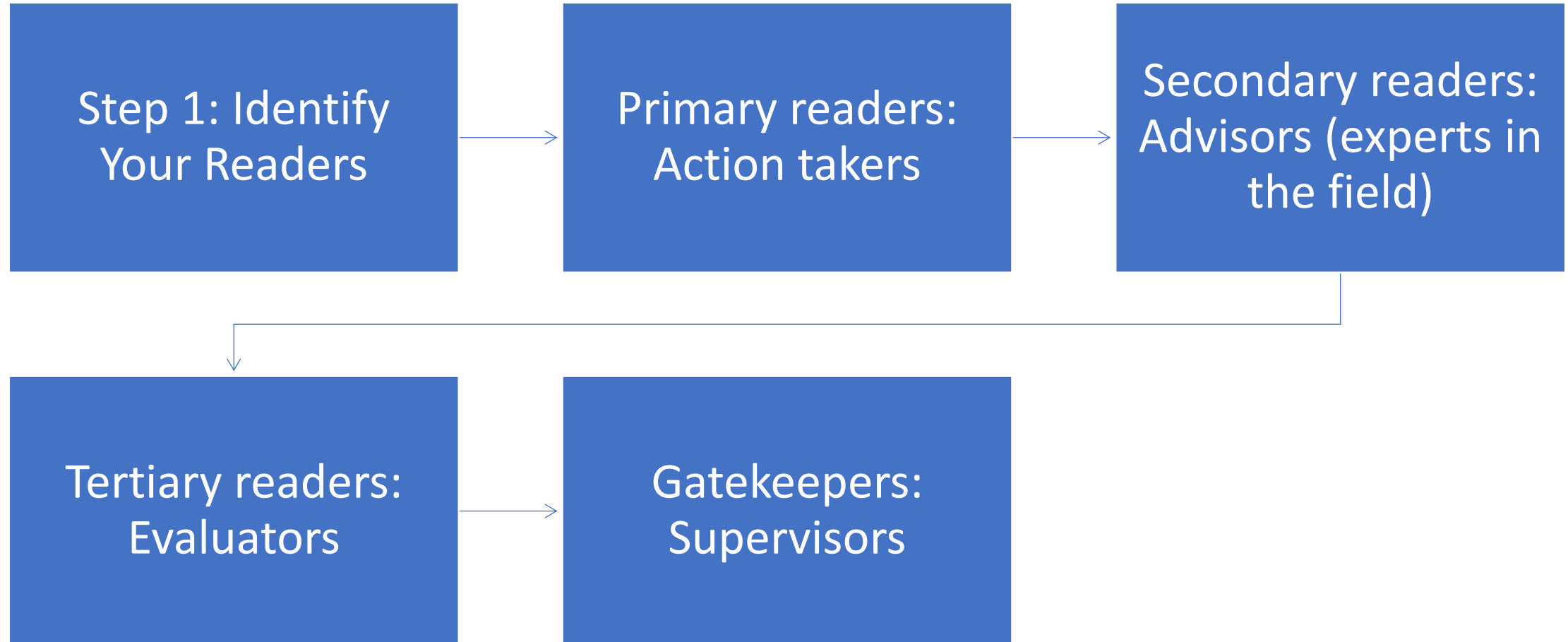
Motivate people to take action

Needs, both fundamental needs and higher-order needs

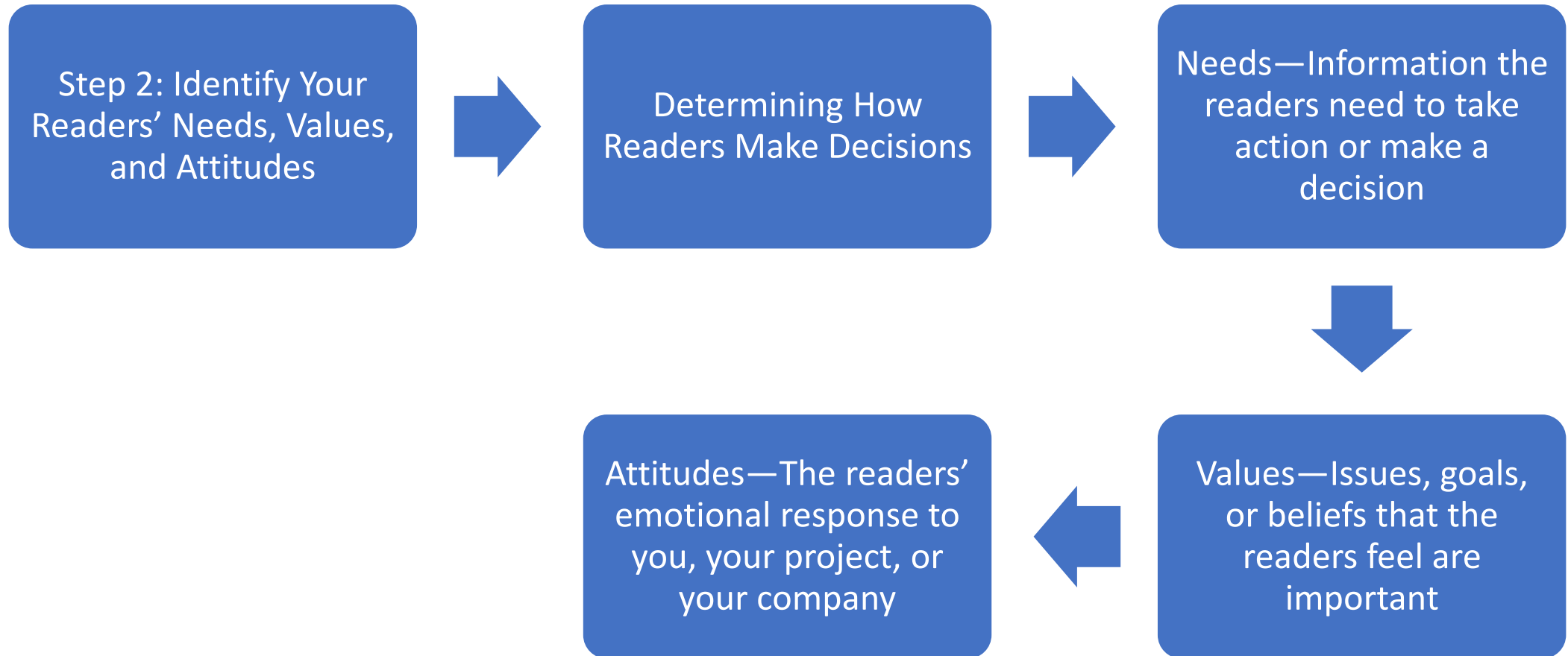
Values that come from their community, culture, family, and experiences

Attitudes about you, your team, and your company

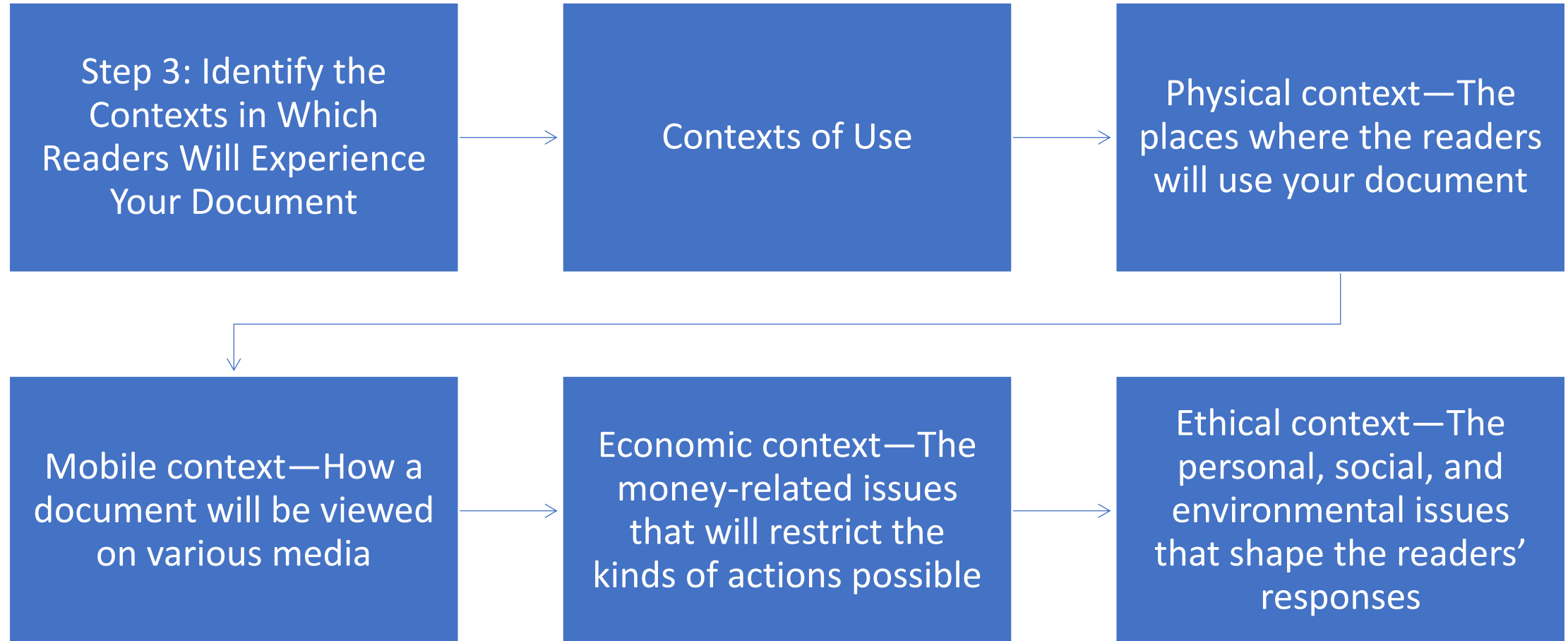
Creating a Reader Profile



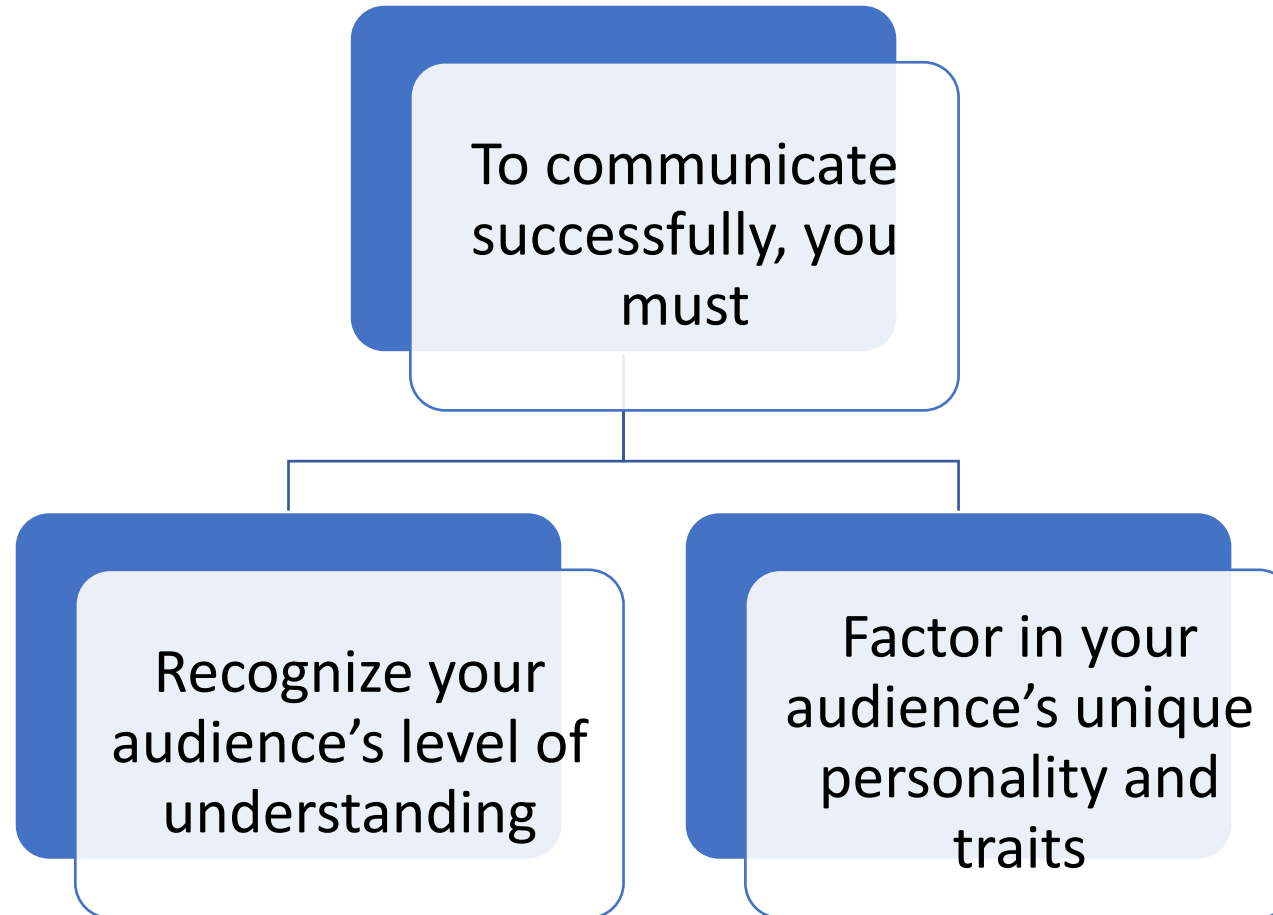
Creating a Reader Profile



Creating a Reader Profile



Successful Communication



Audience Variables

TABLE 4.1 Audience Variables

Knowledge of Subject Matter

- High tech
- Low tech
- Lay
- Multiple

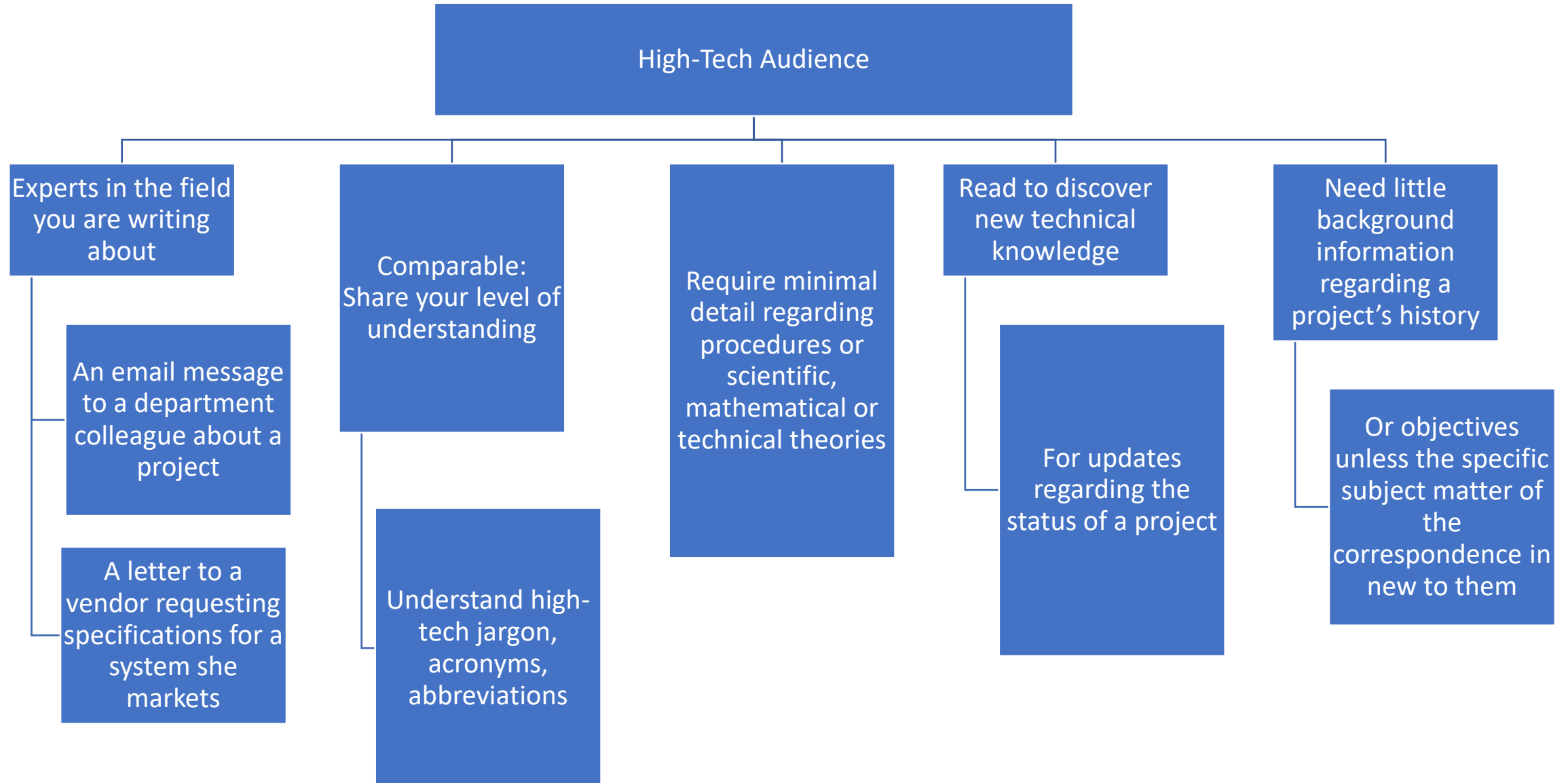
Personality Traits

- Audience's perceived personality
- Audience's attitude or position regarding the topic
- Audience's preference regarding style
- Audience's response to the topic

Issues of Diversity

- Age
 - Gender
 - Race and/or religion
 - Sexual orientation
 - Language and/or culture of origin—multicultural or cross-cultural
-

Knowledge of Subject Matter



E-mail to High-Tech Audience

- This e-mail is written to high-tech readers, uses terminologies without explanation or understanding. Its tone is businesslike and directive.

FIGURE 4.1 E-mail Message to High-Tech Audience

Date: June 15, 2012

To: HVAC Personnel

From: Fatai Sayanti, Facilities Manager

Subject: Security of HVAC

Due to increased concerns about the possibility of terrorist threats, our company is installing an interconnected wireless HVAC system and wireless security system. These two systems will be interconnected through a common wireless technology, using the same frequency modulation and protocols.

Wireless Technology

The HVAC system uses wireless control systems, including RF, IR, and protocols such as 802.11x, Bluetooth, and IRDA₅. We will install one wireless thermostat with a transceiver for controlling the HVAC system.

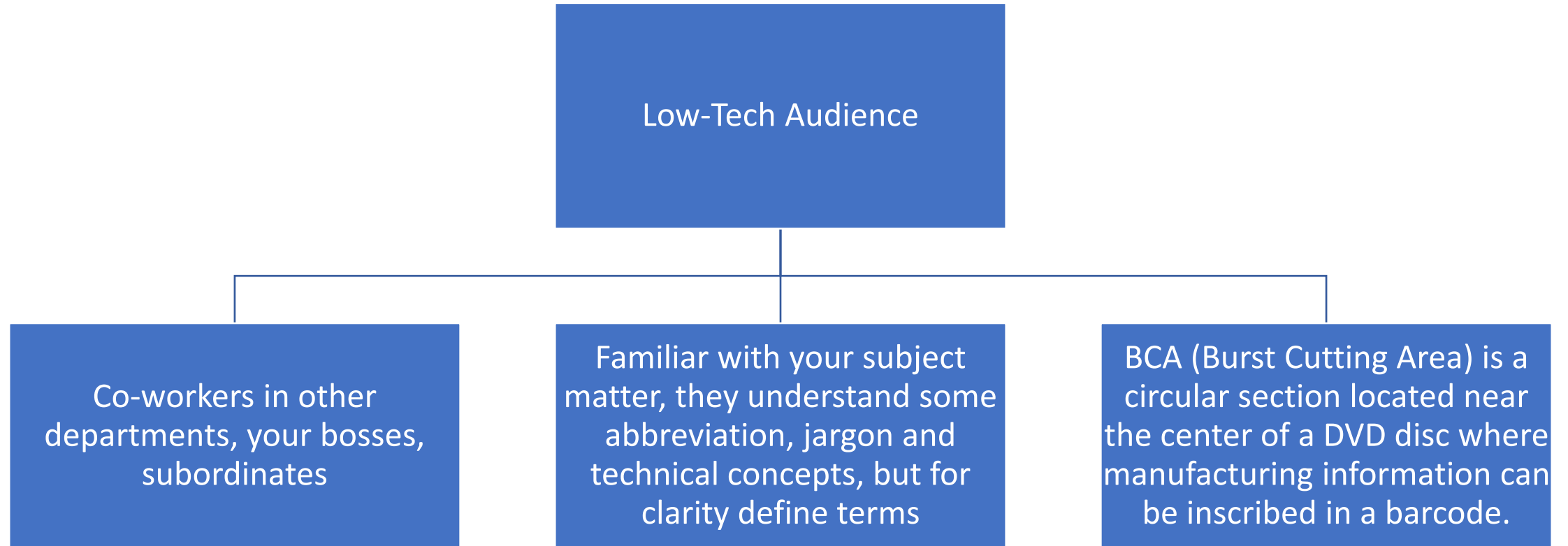
Improved HVAC Capabilities

This new security system will include the following:

- Wireless CO sensors and wireless smoke or fire detectors
- Wireless control keypads for communicating with and controlling the security system
- IR sensors to detect the presence of employees in rooms
- Room controls to regulate the temperature of unoccupied rooms
- GUIs to provide programmable thermostats
- An air quality sensor configured to monitor toxicity levels and presence of foreign substances

Next week, you will receive training for installation and monitoring of this new security system.

Knowledge of Subject Matter



This e-mail to low-tech readers deals with a very important subject (security in the face of potential terrorism). The writer presents only what the audience needs to know in order to complete their job responsibilities. The writer conveys this content simply, using short sentences, a list, and easy-to-understand words. HVAC is defined.

FIGURE 4.2 E-mail Message to Low-Tech Audience

Date: June 15, 2012

To: Security Personnel

From: Fatai Sayanti, Facilities Manager

Subject: Security of Heating, Ventilating, and Air Conditioning (HVAC)

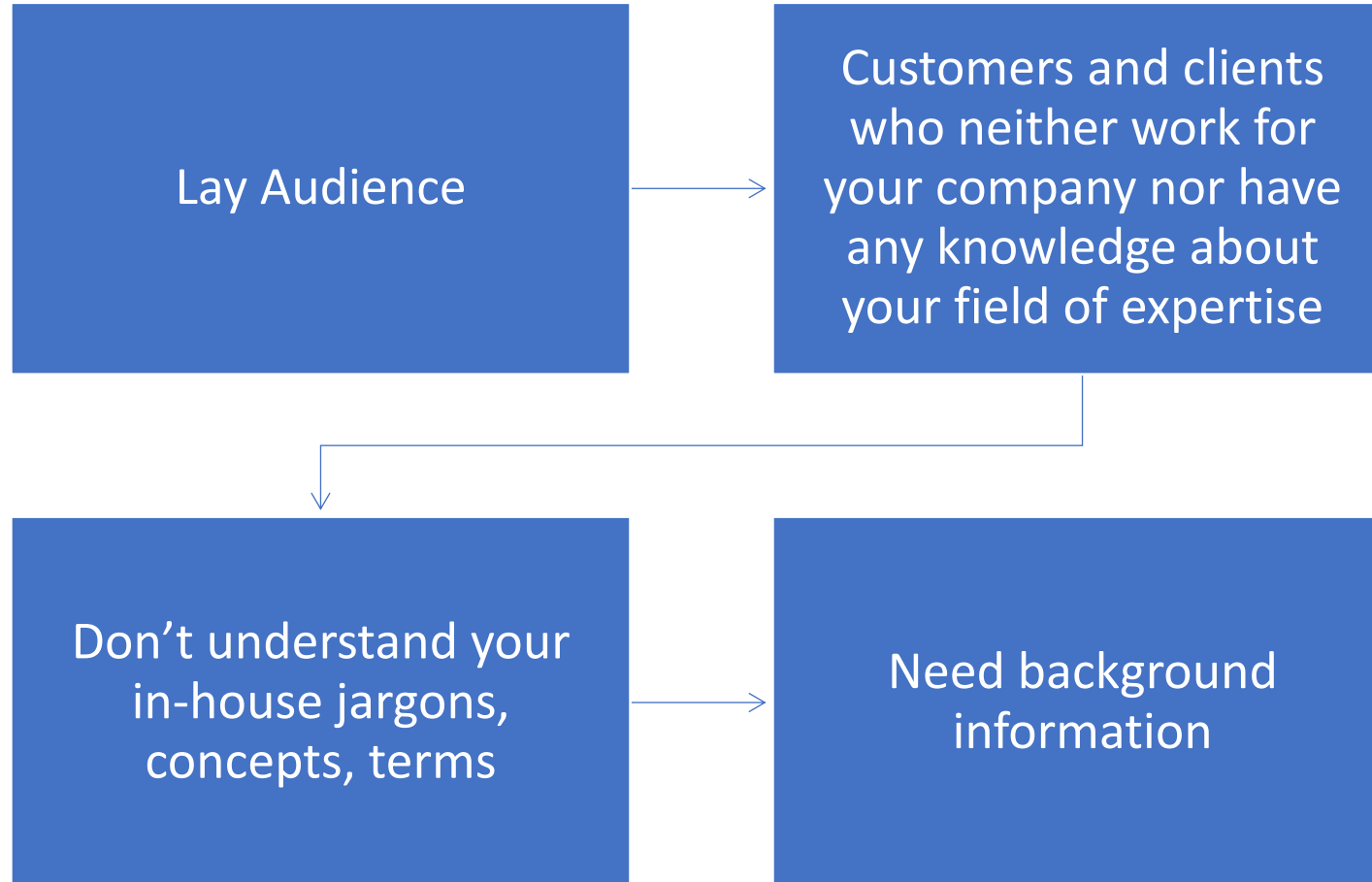
When you are patrolling the facilities and grounds, be on the alert for suspicious substances, such as fine powders, residues, fog, mist, oily liquids, or unusual odors. Not every liquid or odor is necessarily suspicious. Just focus on those with unexplainable origins. Also watch for discomfort in our employees, such as two or more people experiencing difficulty breathing. These signs could be evidence of dangerous chemicals in our HVAC system.

If you discover problems, follow these procedures:

- DO NOT touch the substance.
- Evacuate all employees from the affected area.
- Contact our HVAC personnel and ask them to shut down all systems to avoid spreading contamination.
- Secure the area.
- Report the situation to management, including the location, number of affected employees, and a description of the substance.

As first responders, your alertness and professionalism are essential to ensure the safety of our 5,000 employees.

Knowledge of Subject Matter



Knowledge of Subject Matter

TABLE 4.2 How to Communicate to Different Audience Levels

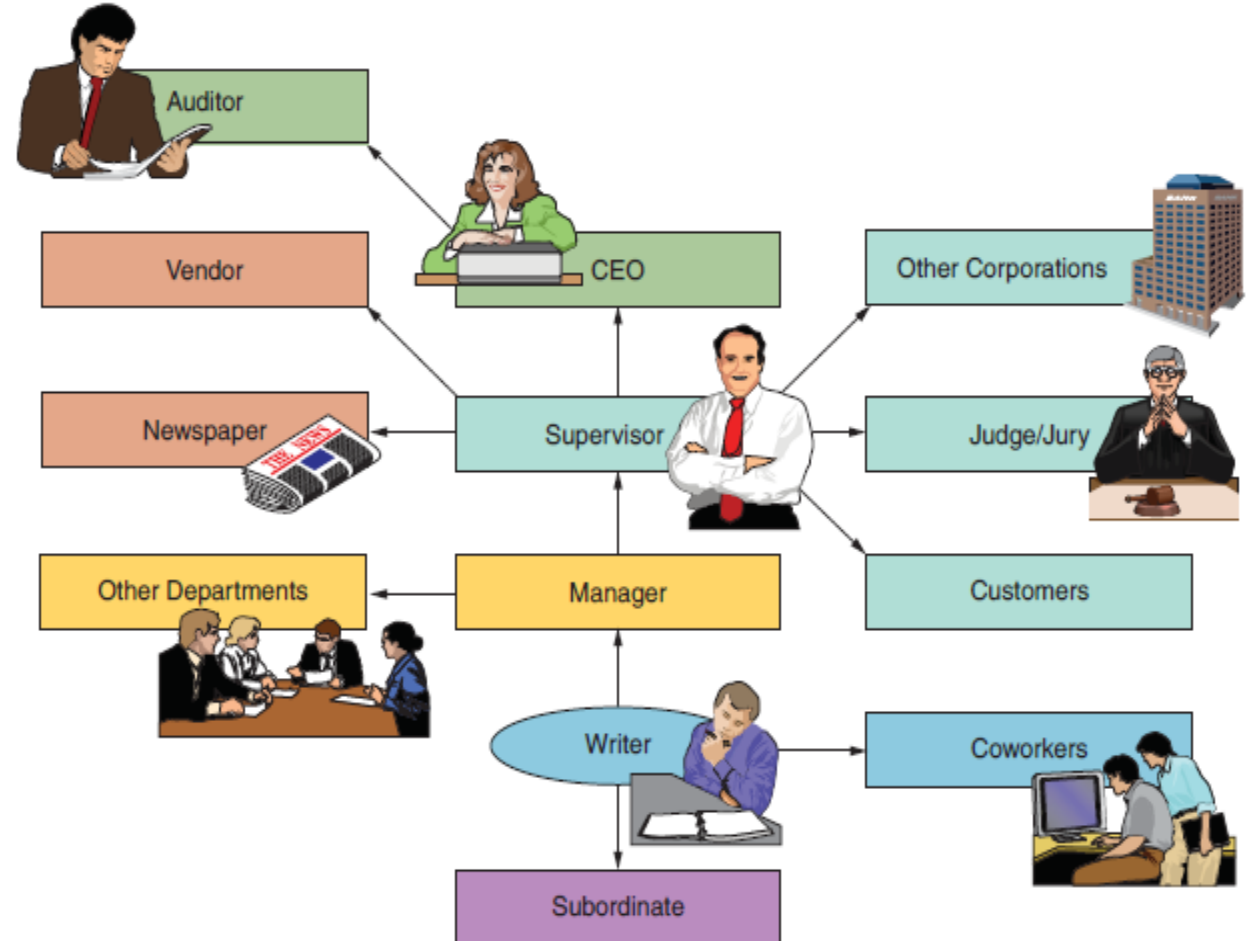
Audience Level	How to Communicate	Sample
High Tech	Use jargon, acronym, or abbreviation alone.	The wastewater is being treated for DBPs.
Low Tech	Use jargon, acronym, or abbreviation with a parenthetical definition.	The wastewater is being treated for DBPs (disinfection by-products).
Lay	Use jargon, acronym, or abbreviation with a parenthetical definition and a brief explanation or extended definition.	The wastewater is being treated for DBPs (disinfection by-products), such as acid, methane, chlorine, and ammonia.

Knowledge of Subject Matter

Multiple
Audience

High-tech, low-
tech and lay

FIGURE 4.5 Examples of Possible Audiences





Knowledge of Subject Matter

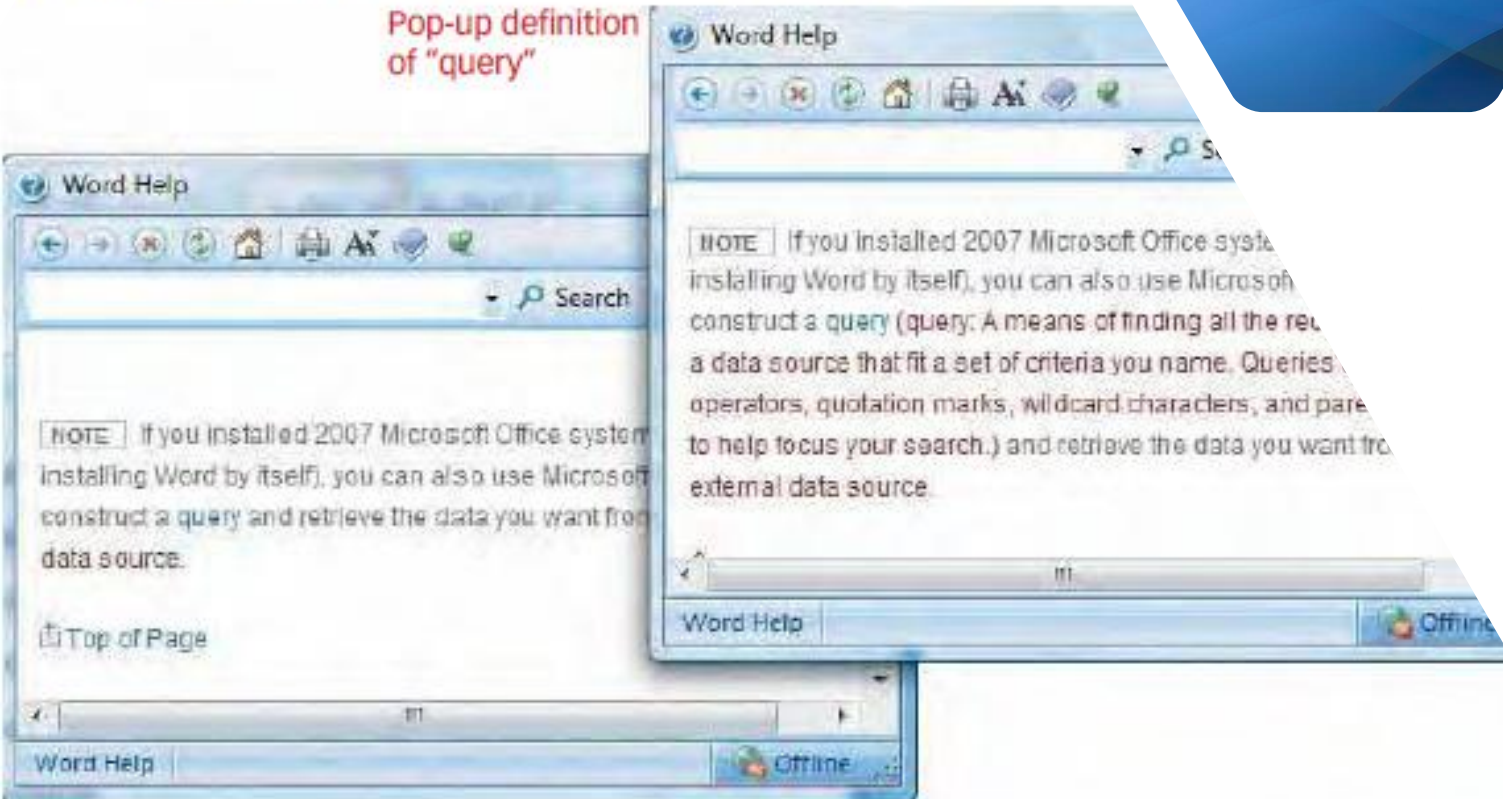
- Writing for Future Audiences
- These readers could include
 - Judges and juries who depend on past reports to decide cases
 - New employees in a company who retrieve archived documents to learn how to complete current tasks
 - Accountants and auditors who look past records to find what work was accomplished at a prior date
 - New managers or supervisors who need to familiarize themselves with workplace procedures

GLOSSARY

ADC	analog to digital converter
Analog	a variable signal continuous in both time and amplitude
DAC	digital to analog converter
LAN	local area network
PSTN	Public Switched Telephone Network—analogue phone system
ROI	return on investment
Voice signal	allows users to access phone options with a single voice
VoIP	voice over Internet protocol
WAN	wide area network

FIGURE 4.6 Online Help Screen with Pop-up Definition

Pop-up definition
of "query"



Define Terms for Audiences

Parenthetically

In a sentence

In an extended paragraph

In a glossary

As online help with a pop-up definition

Audience Personality Traits

TABLE 4.3 Audience Personality Traits and Responses

Audience's perceived personality

- Slow to act?
- Eager?
- Receptive?
- Questioning?
- Organized?
- Disorganized?
- Oppositional?

Audience's attitude or position regarding the topic

- Negative?
- Positive?
- Noncommittal?
- Informed?
- Uninformed?

Audience's preference regarding style

- Will he, she, or they accept contractions?
- Should you use first names, last names, or position titles?
- Is short and to-the-point better?
- Is long and detailed better?

Desired audience response

- Do you want the audience to consider this idea and pass on a recommendation?
 - Do you want the audience to act now?
 - Do you want the audience to confirm what has been suggested?
 - Do you want the audience to reject some options but act on others?
 - Do you want the audience to file this information for future reference?
-

Issues of Diversity

- It includes gender, race/ethnicity, religion, age, sexual orientation, class, physical and mental characteristics, language, family issues, departmental issues.
- Why should you consider about a diverse audience?
 1. Diversity is protected by the law
 2. Respecting diversity is the right thing to do
 3. Diversity is good for business
 4. A diverse workforce keeps companies competitive

Any Questions?

